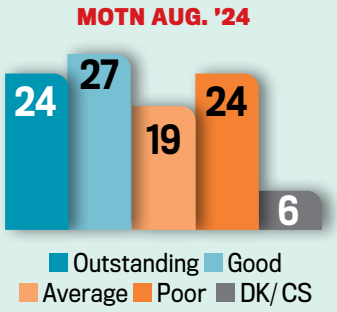
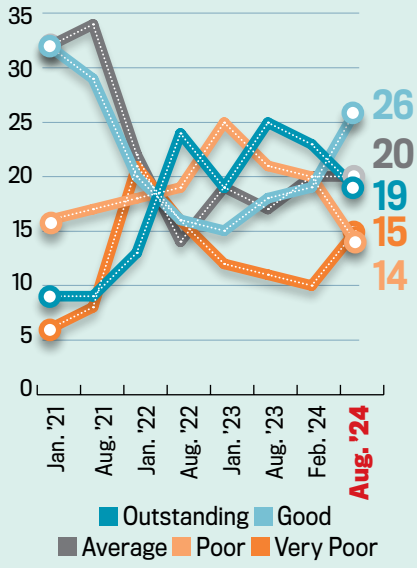
Q. How do you evaluate Rahul Gandhi's performance as Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha?



The evisceration of the 'hate campaign', the asides from the Mahabharata, the public has taken to Rahul's new avatar

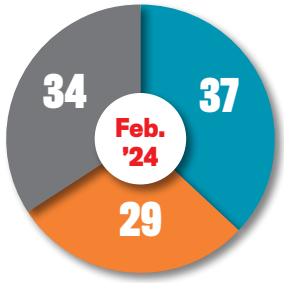
Q. How would you rate the performance of the Congress as an Opposition party?

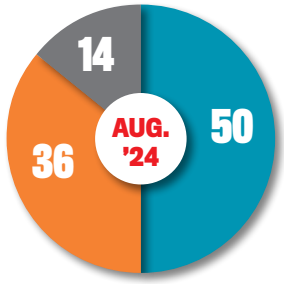


All figures in % and rounded off; rest, others & DK/CS

The party still has a long way to go, but the slide seems to have been arrested

Q. What is your view on regional parties being part of a coalition government at the Centre?





It's perfectly fine as they represent local interests at a national level
No, they ignore issues of national interest because of parochial considerations
DK/CS

Regional parties make a dramatic comeback, as evident in the LS numbers and in people's minds

24%

of respondents from among the upper caste Hindus rate Rahul Gandhi's performance as Leader of the Opposition very poor

BUOYANT CONGRESS

Rahul's enhanced image has also translated into a better perception about the Congress's role as an Opposition party. In the latest MOTN poll, 44.3 per cent respondents rate the Congress's performance as an Opposition party as either outstanding or good, compared to 41.4 per cent in February. But there are worrying signs too—only 18.5 per cent rate the Congress's performance as outstanding, a drop from 22.7 per cent in February. This decline, coupled with 28 per cent rating the party's performance as poor or very poor, suggests that the Congress still struggles to convince a quarter of the electorate of its efficacy as a robust Opposition force.

The survey also explored public opinion on the role of regional parties in coalition governments at the Centre. A resounding 50 per cent of the respondents, up from 37.2 per cent in February, expressed support for regional parties participating in coalition governments, recognising their role in representing local interests at the national level. However, 36 per cent voiced concerns that these parties might prioritise parochial considerations over national interests. This divide reflects the broader debate on federalism and the balance of power between regional and national interests in India's complex political fabric.

The results of the India Today Mood of the Nation Survey offer a nuanced view of the current political climate concerning the Congress and other Opposition parties. While Rahul's leadership is gaining traction, the overall performance of the Opposition forces remains under scrutiny. United, they may put up a fight against the BJP, but the regional leaders too must build a coherent narrative around themselves to gain broader public confidence. ■